

Rajesh Dammala

Technical Operations Manager — Internal Tooling, AI Automation & Integrations

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<https://rdammala.github.io/Customer-io-Technical-Operations-Manager/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical operations and automation leader with 16+ years building internal tooling, integrations, and AI-assisted workflows in fast-paced, startup-style environments. Combines a builder mentality (ship a working version fast) with high ownership and pragmatic documentation. Hands-on with Python, PowerShell, API/webhook integrations, and AI agent infrastructure; administers SaaS stacks (Google Workspace, Slack, 1Password, Linear/Jira) and applies SOC 2 / GDPR-aware operational controls. Surfaces operational friction proactively and turns toil into durable, self-serve systems.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!'98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built an internal AI support agent and incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution.
- Automated operational toil with Python/PowerShell, saving thousands of manual hours annually.
- Built integrations across internal systems (APIs/webhooks) to remove manual handoffs.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts while sustaining 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Led teams of 15-32 with a builder mentality and high ownership.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Internal Tooling & Automation: Python, PowerShell, Bash, TypeScript / Node.js (working), n8n / workflow automation (familiar), API & Webhook Integrations

AI & Agents: AI Agent Infrastructure, LLMs / RAG (applied), MCP (familiar), Evals (applied), AI-Assisted Ops Tooling

Cloud & Platforms: GCP (concepts), Microsoft Azure, SaaS Administration, CI/CD (Azure DevOps, GitHub)

SaaS Stack: Google Workspace, Slack, 1Password, Linear / Jira, Notion / Confluence, Kandji / MDM (familiar)

Operations: ITSM & Ticketing, SLA & Metrics, Runbooks & Documentation, Continuous Improvement

Security & Compliance: SOC 2 / ISO 27001 (concepts), GDPR-aware ops, Access Controls, Operational Controls

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Internal Tooling & Automation (Python/PowerShell) — Expert
API & Webhook Integrations — Advanced
AI Agent Infrastructure & Applied LLMs — Advanced
SaaS Administration (Workspace/Slack/Linear/1Password) — Advanced
ITSM, Ticketing & Operational Metrics — Expert
TypeScript / Node.js — Working
Security & Compliance (SOC 2 / GDPR-aware) — Advanced
Cross-functional Communication — Expert

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Operations & Automation Manager — Xbox Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present
Builds and scales internal tooling and automation that keeps a 24/7/365 platform running.

- Build AI-assisted internal tooling — partnered on agent infrastructure and shipped an internal AI support agent reaching 30-35% auto-resolution.
- Identify operational toil across teams and automate it quickly with Python and PowerShell, leaving behind documentation that lets others self-serve.
- Build integrations across the stack (ticketing, monitoring, collaboration) via APIs and webhooks to remove manual handoffs.
- Operate like a startup — broad scope, fast iteration, high ownership; ship a small working version quickly over planning the perfect system.
- Partner across BizOps-style stakeholders (Engineering, Security, Operations) to understand the real problem and start shipping with minimal direction.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; sustained 100% SLA across 20+ services.

Automation & Platform Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021
Led a 15-engineer team building internal automation and platform tooling.

- Led 15 engineers building internal tools and automation; set priorities and raised execution quality.
- Built integrations and workflow automation across internal systems, reducing manual toil for ops and support.
- Wrote runbooks and documentation enabling self-service across teams.
- Partnered with Security on access controls and compliance-aligned operational controls.

Operations & Tooling Lead — Live Site

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016
Led 12 senior + 20 engineers building operational automation at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Built PowerShell automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation saving thousands of manual hours.
- Standardized documentation and operational workflows across distributed teams.
- Ran incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers into technical leads.

Systems Analyst / Automation Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure operations and scripting across enterprise environments.

- Scripted repetitive operational tasks; executed migrations and patch deployments.
- Documented procedures and improved consistency of recurring operations.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

AI-Assisted Internal Tooling — Partnered on agent infrastructure and shipped an internal AI support agent (30-35% auto-resolution) with applied evals and guardrails to keep responses accurate and safe.

Cross-Stack Integrations — Built API/webhook integrations across ticketing, monitoring, and collaboration tools (Slack, Linear/Jira, Notion) to remove manual handoffs and keep systems in sync.

Toil-to-Automation Pipeline — Identified recurring toil across BizOps, People, and Engineering workflows and automated it with Python/PowerShell, leaving self-serve documentation behind so others could maintain it.

Operational Visibility & Reporting — Built reporting and workflows across ITSM and SaaS tooling lifting efficiency 85% to 98% and eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.

SaaS Lifecycle & Access Governance — Administered Google Workspace, Slack, and 1Password with provisioning, RBAC, and access reviews aligned to SOC 2 / GDPR-aware controls.

GenAI Adoption Enablement — Drove safe adoption of GenAI tooling across operations — prompt patterns, evals, and documentation — while maintaining quality and compliance standards.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Build a small working version fast, ship it, and document it so others can self-serve. I surface operational friction before it escalates, automate toil, and hold a credible technical conversation with a CTO or a finance manager equally well.